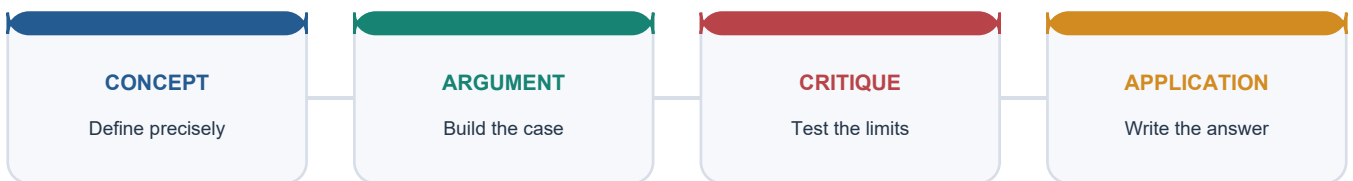


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Diverse Perspectives on Justice - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Diverse Perspectives on Justice - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 20 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Answer:?**

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned redistribution.
- C. Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.
- D. Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Correct attachment: the source records this exact proposition - rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: legitimate government is limited mainly to protection, enforcement and rectification rather than patterned is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Source disagrees: sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

- **D: D Misplaced:** Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Rawls's distributive object by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- B. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- C. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- D. Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A: A Wrong attachment:** the condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B: B This is the recorded association:** the source records this exact proposition - Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- **C: C Misplaced:** communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D: D Belongs elsewhere:** Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational.

MCQ 3

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
- B. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.
- C. The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- D. Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A: A Source disagrees:** communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B: B Misplaced:** Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

- **C:** C Matches the record: the source records this exact proposition - the condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their.

MCQ 4

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. appropriation of an indispensable resource shows that initial acquisition is not morally unlimited.
- B. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- C. Rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings the greatest benefit to the least advantaged.
- D. Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: appropriation of an indispensable resource shows that initial acquisition is not morally unlimited is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Cross-attached: rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings the greatest benefit to the least advantaged is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Exact pair: the source records this exact proposition - rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Rawls's first principle by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Rawls's first principle.

MCQ 5

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality.
- B. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- C. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- D. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Matches the record: the source records this exact proposition - rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Mismatched: rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

- **D:** D Not this pair: rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions.

MCQ 6

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy.
- B. Rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings the greatest benefit to the least advantaged.
- C. injustice in acquisition or transfer must be corrected before present holdings can count as entitled.
- D. appropriation of an indispensable resource shows that initial acquisition is not morally unlimited.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Cross-attached: anarchist justice prefers decentralised association, mutual aid and consent to coercive hierarchy is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Exact pair: the source records this exact proposition - rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings the greatest benefit to the least advantaged.
- **C:** C Not this pair: injustice in acquisition or transfer must be corrected before present holdings can count as entitled is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: appropriation of an indispensable resource shows that initial acquisition is not morally unlimited is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Rawls's rule that inequality is just only if it brings.

MCQ 7

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
- B. Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality.
- C. Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- D. Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Not this pair: rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Source-exact: the source records this exact proposition - nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from.

MCQ 8

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty.
- B. justice must protect the dignity, agency and fair reward of structurally subordinated groups.
- C. one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres.
- D. persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: justice must protect the dignity, agency and fair reward of structurally subordinated groups is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Source disagrees: one social good, especially money, should not purchase dominance across all other spheres is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Faithful pairing: the source records this exact proposition - persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how others and the state may use them.

Examiner trap: Do not identify persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is persons possess rights over themselves that constrain how.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Veil of ignorance - Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448)
- B. Original position - The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447)
- C. Primary goods - Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447)
- D. Equal basic liberties - Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality. (PDF p.448)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: Veil of ignorance is recorded with the condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447).
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Original position is recorded with rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447).
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: Primary goods is recorded with rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect. (PDF p.447).
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Equal basic liberties is recorded with rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Veil of ignorance - Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Primary goods - Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447)
- B. Equal basic liberties - Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality. (PDF p.448)
- C. Veil of ignorance - Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448)
- D. Original position - The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447)

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: Primary goods is recorded with Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect. (PDF p.447).
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Equal basic liberties is recorded with Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448).
- **C:** C Belongs elsewhere: Veil of ignorance is recorded with the condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447).
- **D:** D Misplaced: Original position is recorded with Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Equal basic liberties - Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Equal basic liberties.

MCQ 11

Which pair keeps the proposition with the name or concept the source attaches it to?

- A. Veil of ignorance - Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448)
- B. Original position - The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447)
- C. Primary goods - Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447)
- D. Equal basic liberties - Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality. (PDF p.448)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Cross-attached: Veil of ignorance is recorded with the condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447).
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Original position is recorded with Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447).
- **C:** C Misplaced: Primary goods is recorded with Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect. (PDF p.447).

- **D: D Mismatched:** Equal basic liberties is recorded with Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Primary goods - Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Primary goods.

MCQ 12

Which pairing is exact, rather than borrowed from an adjacent part of the same topic?

- A. Primary goods - Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447)
- B. Original position - The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447)
- C. Equal basic liberties - Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality. (PDF p.448)
- D. Veil of ignorance - Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448)

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A: A Belongs elsewhere:** Primary goods is recorded with Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect. (PDF p.447).
- **B: B Cross-attached:** Original position is recorded with Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447).
- **C: C Not this pair:** Equal basic liberties is recorded with Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448).
- **D: D Mismatched:** Veil of ignorance is recorded with the condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Veil of ignorance - Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Veil of ignorance.

MCQ 13

One pairing below is faithful to the source. Which one?

- A. Primary goods - Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447)
- B. Original position - The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447)
- C. Veil of ignorance - Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448)
- D. Equal basic liberties - Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality. (PDF p.448)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A: A Cross-attached:** Primary goods is recorded with Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect. (PDF p.447).
- **B: B Mismatched:** Original position is recorded with Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447).

- **C:** C Not this pair: Veil of ignorance is recorded with the condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447).
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Equal basic liberties is recorded with Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Primary goods - Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; tested item 2: Primary goods - Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational per.

MCQ 14

Which label-proposition pair would not be corrected by the source text?

- A. Primary goods - Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447)
- B. Original position - The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447)
- C. Veil of ignorance - Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448)
- D. Equal basic liberties - Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality. (PDF p.448)

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Primary goods is recorded with Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect. (PDF p.447).
- **B:** B Not this pair: Original position is recorded with Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447).
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: Veil of ignorance is recorded with the condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447).
- **D:** D Source disagrees: Equal basic liberties is recorded with Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Original position - The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Original position.

MCQ 15

Which of the following associations is reproduced exactly as recorded?

- A. Primary goods - Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447)
- B. Original position - The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447)
- C. Veil of ignorance - Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448)
- D. Equal basic liberties - Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality. (PDF p.448)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Primary goods is recorded with Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect. (PDF p.447).

- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Original position is recorded with Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447).
- **C:** C Source disagrees: Veil of ignorance is recorded with the condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447).
- **D:** D Misplaced: Equal basic liberties is recorded with Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Veil of ignorance - Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; tested item 2: Veil of ignorance - Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal.

MCQ 16

Which pair matches its proposition without drifting to a related concept?

- A. Equal basic liberties - Rawls's second-stage rule that offices and positions should be open on genuinely fair terms, not merely formal legal equality. (PDF p.448)
- B. Original position - The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447)
- C. Veil of ignorance - Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448)
- D. Primary goods - Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447)

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Equal basic liberties is recorded with Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty. (PDF p.448).
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Original position is recorded with Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place. (PDF p.447).
- **C:** C Misplaced: Veil of ignorance is recorded with the condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers. (PDF p.447).
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Primary goods is recorded with Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect. (PDF p.447).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Primary goods - Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; tested item 3: Primary goods - Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational per.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: justice must protect the dignity, agency and fair reward of structurally subordinated groups.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: status subordination or public devaluation can remain unjust even when some material redistribution occurs.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 1 only does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 2 only does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is 2 only.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Communitarian idea that persons discover themselves within social roles, traditions and shared ends, not in abstraction from them.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Sen and Nussbaum shift attention from resources held to real freedoms and functionings; this is a supplementary extension.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.

- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Both 1 and 2 does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is Both 1 and 2.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Neither 1 nor 2 does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is Neither 1 nor 2.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Gauba's explanatory image stresses social interdependence but does not replace Rawls's two principles or their priority.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Rawls's first principle: each person has an equal claim to the most extensive compatible liberty.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 1 only does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is 1 only.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Rawls's distributive object: rights, liberties, powers, opportunities, income, wealth and the social bases of self-respect.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 2 only does not validate the second pairing; tested item 2: 2 only.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Fraser's recognition framework asks whether persons can interact as peers across distribution, status and representation.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Rawls's hypothetical starting point where rational persons choose principles of justice without knowing their actual social place.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Both 1 and 2 does not validate the second pairing; tested item 2: Both 1 and 2.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: The condition in which parties lack knowledge of their particular wants, talents, class position and other discriminatory markers.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Nozick's view that holdings are just if they arise from just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where needed, rectification.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Neither 1 nor 2 does not validate the second pairing; tested item 2: Neither 1 nor 2.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Rawls wants identical outcomes for all.**?

- A. Rawls permits inequality after liberty and fair opportunity, provided it benefits the least advantaged. (PDF p.448)
- B. Nozick proposes a full theory of justice, but one centred on entitlement rather than redistribution. (PDF pp.451-452)
- C. Gauba also notes claims for maternity benefits and compensatory support rooted in actual disadvantage. (PDF pp.466-468)
- D. The criticism is directed at the abstract self and ethical neutrality, not at the very idea of justice. (PDF pp.469-473)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Rawls permits inequality after liberty and fair opportunity, provided it benefits the least advantaged. (PDF p.448).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Nozick is anti-justice.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Feminism only demands that women be treated exactly like men in every situation.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Communitarian criticism means justice should give way to blind conformity.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Rawls wants identical outcomes for all, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **The difference principle alone is enough to justify an inequality.**?

- A. The transfer must rest on just title;
- B. Equal basic liberties and
- C. It explicitly insists on freedom of thought.
- D. Rawls permits inequality after liberty and fair.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Any voluntary market transfer is just for Nozick.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Equal basic liberties and.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Democratic socialism is just Marxism without elections.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Rawls wants identical outcomes for all.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about The difference principle alone is enough to justify, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Nozick is anti-justice.**?

- A. The criticism is directed at the abstract self and ethical neutrality, not at the very idea of justice. (PDF pp.469-473)
- B. Rawls permits inequality after liberty and fair opportunity, provided it benefits the least advantaged. (PDF p.448)
- C. Nozick proposes a full theory of justice, but one centred on entitlement rather than redistribution. (PDF pp.451-452)
- D. Gauba also notes claims for maternity benefits and compensatory support rooted in actual disadvantage. (PDF pp.466-468)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Communitarian criticism means justice should give way to blind conformity.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Rawls wants identical outcomes for all.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Nozick proposes a full theory of justice, but one centred on entitlement rather than redistribution. (PDF pp.451-452).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Feminism only demands that women be treated exactly like men in every situation.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Nozick is anti-justice, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Any voluntary market transfer is just for Nozick.**?

- A. Equal basic liberties and
- B. Rawls permits inequality after liberty and fair opportunity.
- C. It explicitly insists on freedom of thought.
- D. The transfer must rest on just title;

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'The difference principle alone is enough to justify an inequality.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Rawls wants identical outcomes for all.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Democratic socialism is just Marxism without elections.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: The transfer must rest on just title;.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Any voluntary market transfer is just for Nozick, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Marxism has nothing to do with justice.**?

- A. Gauba says that would be too strong, because Marx condemns exploitation and endorses superior distributive principles in a classless order. (PDF p.453)
- B. The criticism is directed at the abstract self and ethical neutrality, not at the very idea of justice. (PDF pp.469-473); this option treats that proposition as the decisive account.
- C. Gauba also notes claims for maternity benefits and compensatory support rooted in actual disadvantage. (PDF pp.466-468); the rival mechanism is treated as non-decisive in this account.
- D. Nozick proposes a full theory of justice, but one centred on entitlement rather than redistribution. (PDF pp.451-452); this formulation is presented as sufficient for the classification.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba says that would be too strong, because Marx condemns exploitation and endorses superior distributive principles in a classless order. (PDF p.453).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Communitarian criticism means justice should give way to blind conformity.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Feminism only demands that women be treated exactly like men in every situation.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Nozick is anti-justice.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Marxism has nothing to do with justice, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Democratic socialism is just Marxism without elections.**?

- A. Rawls permits inequality after liberty and fair opportunity, provided it benefits the least advantaged. (PDF p.448)
- B. It explicitly insists on freedom of thought, multi-party competition and opposition rights. (PDF pp.460-461)
- C. Nozick proposes a full theory of justice, but one centred on entitlement rather than redistribution. (PDF pp.451-452)
- D. Gauba also notes claims for maternity benefits and compensatory support rooted in actual disadvantage. (PDF pp.466-468)

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Rawls wants identical outcomes for all.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: It explicitly insists on freedom of thought, multi-party competition and opposition rights. (PDF pp.460-461).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Nozick is anti-justice.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Feminism only demands that women be treated exactly like men in every situation.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Democratic socialism is just Marxism without elections, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Feminism only demands that women be treated exactly like men in every situation.**?

- A. The criticism is directed at the abstract self and ethical neutrality, not at the very idea of justice. (PDF pp.469-473)
- B. Nozick proposes a full theory of justice, but one centred on entitlement rather than redistribution. (PDF pp.451-452)
- C. Gauba also notes claims for maternity benefits and compensatory support rooted in actual disadvantage. (PDF pp.466-468)
- D. Rawls permits inequality after liberty and fair opportunity, provided it benefits the least advantaged. (PDF p.448)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Communitarian criticism means justice should give way to blind conformity.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Nozick is anti-justice.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba also notes claims for maternity benefits and compensatory support rooted in actual disadvantage. (PDF pp.466-468).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Rawls wants identical outcomes for all.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Feminism only demands that women be treated exactly, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Communitarian criticism means justice should give way to blind conformity.**?

- A. Rawls permits inequality after liberty and fair opportunity, provided it benefits the least advantaged. (PDF p.448)
- B. Gauba also notes claims for maternity benefits and compensatory support rooted in actual disadvantage. (PDF pp.466-468)
- C. Nozick proposes a full theory of justice, but one centred on entitlement rather than redistribution. (PDF pp.451-452)
- D. The criticism is directed at the abstract self and ethical neutrality, not at the very idea of justice. (PDF pp.469-473)

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Rawls wants identical outcomes for all.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Feminism only demands that women be treated exactly like men in every situation.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Nozick is anti-justice.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: The criticism is directed at the abstract self and ethical neutrality, not at the very idea of justice. (PDF pp.469-473).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Communitarian criticism means justice should give, not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

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ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish Rawls's difference principle from Nozick's entitlement theory. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive distinguish requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of Rawls's difference principle from Nozick's entitlement theory in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Rawls's, Nozick's and Rawls, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Rawls and Nozick disagree not merely over equality but over what makes a holding just: fair institutions ordered to the least advantaged versus historically valid title constrained by rectification.

Model answer (150 words):

Introduction: Rawls's difference principle and Nozick's entitlement theory answer inequality through rival moral tests. Rawls judges institutions by fairness to the least advantaged, while Nozick judges holdings by their history. Core analysis: For Rawls, equal basic liberties come first, fair equality of opportunity comes next, and only then may inequalities stand if they improve the position of the least advantaged. Nozick rejects such patterned assessment. He asks whether holdings arose through just acquisition, voluntary transfer and rectification of past injustice under a minimal protective state. Rawls therefore evaluates the basic structure prospectively; Nozick evaluates titles historically. Critical evaluation: Each theory exposes the other's blind spot. Rawls risks underplaying title and

incentive, while Nozick leaves structural inequality and rectification seriously under-specified. Conclusion: Rawls and Nozick disagree not merely over equality but over what makes a holding just: fair institutions ordered to the least advantaged versus historically valid title constrained by rectification.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Rawls's, Nozick's and Rawls), converts that evidence into analysis of Rawls's difference principle from Nozick's entitlement theory, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Rawls and Nozick disagree not merely over equality but over what makes a holding just: fair institutions ordered to the least advantaged versus historically valid title constrained by rectification. At 150 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Why is Walzer's complex equality not simple levelling? Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive why requires the answer to give the grounds, not only the description, and rank them. Fix the boundary of is Walzer's complex equality not simple levelling in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Walzer's, Core and Different, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Walzer's point is not that every sphere must yield identical shares, but that money or power must not buy dominance across unlike goods with distinct social meanings.

Model answer (144 words):

Introduction: Walzer's complex equality is not a call for identical shares of every good. It is a doctrine about protecting distinct social spheres from illegitimate conversion by money or power. Core analysis: Different goods carry different social meanings and should be distributed for different reasons. Political office should not be bought like a commodity, education should not simply follow wealth, and health care should not be reduced to market purchasing power. Simple equality would try to flatten all holdings by one metric. Walzer's alternative is to prevent dominance: advantage in one sphere must not automatically command superiority in another. It explains what should not dominate, yet says less about the precise machinery that secures those boundaries. Conclusion: Walzer's point is not that every sphere must yield identical shares, but that money or power must not buy dominance across unlike goods with distinct social meanings.

Why this earns marks: it obeys why instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Walzer's, Core and Different), converts that evidence into analysis of is Walzer's complex equality not simple levelling, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Walzer's point is not that every sphere must yield identical shares, but that money or power must not buy dominance across unlike goods with distinct social meanings. At 144 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Compare feminist and subaltern critiques of distributive justice. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of feminist and subaltern critiques of distributive justice in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Feminist, Core and Gauba's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Feminist and subaltern critiques deepen distributive justice by showing that formally neutral rules can preserve hierarchy unless power, voice and status injury are made part of the analysis.

Model answer (142 words):

Introduction: Feminist and subaltern critiques challenge justice theories that examine only formal rules or market shares. Both argue that persons enter institutions already marked by hierarchy. Core analysis: Feminist justice shows that equal treatment is inadequate where gendered burdens structure education, property, representation and bodily security. Gauba's own account allows corrective support, not mere identical treatment. Subaltern justice shifts attention to groups whose labour and contribution are undervalued because elite rule and hegemonic narratives make subordination appear natural or consensual. Both critiques therefore widen justice beyond contract and exchange toward power, dignity and voice. Feminist analysis begins from patriarchy and gendered exclusion, whereas subaltern analysis centres structurally marginal agency, hegemony and elite-centred history. Conclusion: Feminist and subaltern critiques deepen distributive justice by showing that formally neutral rules can preserve hierarchy unless power, voice

and status injury are made part of the analysis.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Feminist, Core and Gauba's), converts that evidence into analysis of feminist and subaltern critiques of distributive justice, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Feminist and subaltern critiques deepen distributive justice by showing that formally neutral rules can preserve hierarchy unless power, voice and status injury are made part of the analysis. At 142 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Does Sen improve Rawls, or mainly change the metric of justice? Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive discuss requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of sen improve Rawls, or mainly change the metric of justice in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Sen's, Rawls and He, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Sen improves Rawls most clearly by shifting justice from the distribution of primary goods to the comparison of real freedoms, yet he supplements rather than abolishes the need for institutional principles.

Model answer (231 words):

Introduction: Sen's intervention is best read as a reorientation of justice rather than a simple rejection of Rawls. He asks how far institutions enlarge actual capabilities in lived conditions. Core analysis: Rawls distributes primary goods through principles chosen in the original position for a fair basic structure. Sen argues that equal resources or primary goods can still leave persons unequally free because disability, gendered burdens and social location affect conversion into real functionings. He therefore shifts attention from ideal design to comparative judgment, remediable injustice and public reasoning about what people are actually able to be and do. The metric changes from goods held to freedoms realised. Further development: The key issue is the criterion of improvement. If justice is judged by real freedom and removal of manifest injustice, Sen clearly advances beyond Rawlsian primary goods. If justice also requires a stable ordering of institutions, liberties and offices, Sen supplements rather than supersedes Rawls. A good answer therefore separates metric, method and institutional determinacy before giving its verdict. Critical evaluation: Rawls nevertheless retains an advantage in institutional specification. Sen improves the informational space of justice, but deliberately under-specifies a final set of principles for a fully just basic structure. Conclusion: Sen improves Rawls most clearly by shifting justice from the distribution of primary goods to the comparison of real freedoms, yet he supplements rather than abolishes the need for institutional principles.

Why this earns marks: it obeys discuss instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Sen's, Rawls and He), converts that evidence into analysis of sen improve Rawls, or mainly change the metric of justice, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Sen improves Rawls most clearly by shifting justice from the distribution of primary goods to the comparison of real freedoms, yet he supplements rather than abolishes the need for institutional principles. At 231 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Can justice be exhausted by redistribution? Discuss with Rawls, Fraser and Ambedkarian/subaltern implications. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive can requires the answer to state the conditions under which the claim holds and where they fail. Fix the boundary of justice be exhausted by redistribution? Discuss with Rawls, Fraser and Ambedkarian/subaltern implications in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Rawls and Fraser's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Justice cannot be exhausted by redistribution because status subordination and exclusion from rule-making persist even when transfers occur;.

Model answer (237 words):

Introduction: A purely redistributive account captures only one family of injustice. The justice debate widens once unequal status and exclusion from rule-making are recognised as independent political wrongs. Core analysis: Rawls remains indispensable because he shows why liberties, opportunity and the position of the least advantaged matter to institutional fairness. Yet redistribution alone cannot explain cases where a group remains stigmatised, unheard or publicly devalued even after material transfers occur. Fraser's parity-of-participation bridge therefore adds recognition and representation to distribution. Ambedkarian and subaltern implications, kept as cross-routes rather than proxy

ownership, reinforce the point: graded status, hegemony and monopolised voice cannot be repaired by income measures alone. Further development: The temporal and democratic dimensions sharpen the argument further. Recognition without representation lets elites speak for the injured, while redistribution without recognition may leave the public meaning of inferiority untouched. At the forward boundary, debates on democratisation, democratic backsliding and social movements belong to Topic 23; Topic 20 should only supply the justice standards later used to judge those processes. Critical evaluation: Once justice expands beyond redistribution, new problems arise. Duty-bearers must be specified, remedies must remain reviewable, and not every status injury warrants the same institutional response. Otherwise the cure can become paternal or rhetorically expansive without administrative discipline. Conclusion: Justice cannot be exhausted by redistribution because status subordination and exclusion from rule-making persist even when transfers occur; a defensible answer therefore joins resources, recognition and representation.

Why this earns marks: it obeys can instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Rawls and Fraser's), converts that evidence into analysis of justice be exhausted by redistribution? Discuss with Rawls, Fraser and Ambedkarian/subaltern implications, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Justice cannot be exhausted by redistribution because status subordination and exclusion from rule-making persist even when transfers occur;. At 237 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Evaluate whether democratic socialism is the strongest correction to both libertarianism and Marxist centralism. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive evaluate requires the answer to apply a stated criterion and give a graded verdict, not a summary. Fix the boundary of whether democratic socialism is the strongest correction to both libertarianism and Marxist centralism in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Democratic, Marxist and Core, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Democratic socialism is strongest when it corrects market privilege and Marxist authoritarian risk together, but it remains convincing only if welfare, liberty and democratic accountability are kept institutionally connected.

Model answer (239 words):

Introduction: Democratic socialism presents itself as a middle route between libertarian minimalism and Marxist centralism. It keeps social justice as a public aim while rejecting dictatorship and unregulated market title. Core analysis: Against libertarianism, democratic socialism argues that formal liberty without welfare, public services and fair life-chances entrenches privilege. Against Marxist centralism, it argues that social ownership or regulation must coexist with freedom of thought, party competition, opposition rights and civil liberties. Gauba's account treats it as a constitutional and welfare-oriented correction: partial socialisation, public services and democratic procedure rather than revolutionary monopoly power. Further development: The decisive test is democratic durability. Democratic socialism must fund welfare without administrative arbitrariness, protect labour without silencing opposition, and widen equality without concentrating unreviewable power. Where later questions shift to democratisation, backsliding or movement politics, Topic 23 should own the bridge; Topic 20 should stop at the justice-based criteria by which such regimes are judged. It must also balance welfare delivery with secure opposition rights and contestable public power. Critical evaluation: The position still faces two serious objections. Libertarians question its treatment of title, incentives and state reach, while Marxists question whether capitalism can be humanised without leaving structural domination intact. Its success therefore depends less on slogan than on institutional design. Conclusion: Democratic socialism is strongest when it corrects market privilege and Marxist authoritarian risk together, but it remains convincing only if welfare, liberty and democratic accountability are kept institutionally connected.

Why this earns marks: it obeys evaluate instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Democratic, Marxist and Core), converts that evidence into analysis of whether democratic socialism is the strongest correction to both libertarianism and Marxist centralism, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Democratic socialism is strongest when it corrects market privilege and Marxist authoritarian risk together, but it remains convincing only if welfare, liberty and democratic accountability are kept institutionally connected. At 239 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.
